

Figure 6.3 Example of using a whitelist to find a valid and an invalid Origin header

Listing 6.2 Creating a whiltelist validator function in app.js

```
var createWhitelistValidator = function(whitelist) {
  return function(val) {
    for (var i = 0; i < whitelist.length; i++) {
      if (val === whitelist[i]) {
        return true;
      }
    }
    return false;
  }
};
```

The `createWhitelistValidator` function returns a function that validates an origin value against a whitelist of acceptable origins. The `createWhitelistValidator` function doesn't do the validation itself; it only creates a function that can be used to do the validation later on, when the client sends a request. The validation function loops through each value in the whitelist. If there is a match, the function returns `true`. If the function loops through all the whitelist values without finding a match, it returns `false`. Figure 6.3 provides a visualization of what the whitelist check looks like.

Armed with the `createWhitelistValidator` function, let's validate the origin against the whitelist values. The following listing updates the sample code to validate origins against a whitelist.

Listing 6.3 Using the whitelist validator

```
var originWhitelist = [
  'http://localhost:1111'
];

var corsOptions = {
  allowOrigin: createWhitelistValidator(originWhitelist)
};

var handleCors = function(options) {
  return function(req, res, next) {
```

Defines valid origin values in whitelist

Creates a new function to validate origin